

When the Wolves Came Back

山脊之上，狼影再临

第一段

For decades, the gray **wolf** had been gone from Yellowstone. Without **predators**, this land became a paradise for elk. But **with it came a cost**: the park's ecosystem fell into **disorder**. The elk **population** exploded, the **surplus** soon straining the ecosystem. They **gnawed at the bark without restraint**, leaving trunks bare. As a result, many trees died. Deprived of shade, the **moss** around the trees slowly **withered** and vanished under the **scorching sun**. The damage these **herbivores** caused to the ecosystem was like a deep, gaping **wound** that would not **heal**.

第二段

To **prevent** the situation **from** getting worse, in 1995, officials decided to **reintroduce** wolves. Upon hearing the news, **ranchers** were **indignant**. They **were skeptical about** whether this decision would actually be **carried out**. **To head this off**, ranchers **banded together, objecting** to this plan and demanding **hearings**. They claimed this was an **insult** to their way of life, as wolves would **prey on** their **livestock**. If wolves returned, the constant struggle to **resist** these **vicious** predators would **torment** them **endlessly**. However, ecologists **took the opposite view**. They **cared little for** how the **shepherds** felt; all they wanted was for Yellowstone to **revive**.

第三段

The plan that many had deemed **dubious** went ahead as scheduled, yet the results far exceeded **estimates**. Elk no longer **dared to roam** near the open **ridges**, for **cunning** gray wolves now **lurked** there, ready to **pursue** them at any moment. Free from relentless grazing, greenery returned, its rapid **expansion** soon transforming the entire **panorama**. Where elk had left the land **desolate**, new life now **stretched** across it once more—**lush** and **thriving**. In a Yellowstone reborn, beavers also **made their way back**—to **swamp** and stream.

第四段

Yellowstone's **rebirth** brought unexpected **clarity** on how to **maintain ecological balance** in the future. The key lay not in killing, but in fear. Gray wolves do more than just kill elk and control their numbers; their fierce **disposition instills** lasting fear in their **prey**. As a result, elk now **wander** within a limited range, doing everything they can to avoid places where wolves **howl**. This greatly shrinks the area damaged by elk **grazing**, giving other areas time to recover. It is this behavioral shift that **underlies** much of the **restoration**.

第五段

The **resounding** success soon rippled beyond ecology. Visitors arrived in growing numbers, **hiking** along the valley **rim at their leisure**, hoping to **catch a glimpse of the elusive** gray wolves. Local tourism operators **scored** big—**abundant** revenue **poured in**, giving the economy a significant boost. Ranchers, however, were **up in arms**. As wolf populations grew, so did livestock kills. Some ranchers began organizing hunts on their own. To **defuse** the **rising tensions**, authorities were forced to introduce a **compensation** policy: ranchers who lost livestock could now **file claims**. This **concession** helped **soften** the opposition.

第六段

Other regions now **pursue** similar outcomes. In Germany, wolves have crossed the **border** from Poland—and the boost to ecosystem recovery is already visible. Farmers, though, have **groaned** over their **mounting** losses and **pointed fingers at** government policy. In response, **Parliament** drew up **clauses** to safeguard their interests and property. The **entity** responsible for overseeing wildlife **conceded** limited culls—but kept core populations **intact**.

第七段

Ecologists **counsel** patience. **After all**, ecosystem recovery is not **instantaneous**—it takes decades to restore the **delicate bonds** between species. Yet for all this complexity, Yellowstone offers a **concise** lesson: remove a keystone species, the balance collapses; **revive** it, nature **heals** itself.

翻译:

第一段

For decades, the gray **wolf** had been gone from Yellowstone. 近几十年来，灰狼已经从黄石公园消失了。

Without **predators**, this land became a paradise for elk. 没有了捕食者，这片土地成了麋鹿的天堂。

But **with it came a cost**: the park's ecosystem fell into **disorder**. 但随之而来的代价是：公园的生态系统陷入了混乱。

The elk **population** exploded, the **surplus** soon straining the ecosystem. 麋鹿的数量激增，过剩的种群很快给生态系统带来了巨大压力。

They **gnawed at** the **bark without restraint**, leaving trunks bare. 它们肆无忌惮地啃食树皮，把树干啃得光秃秃的。

As a result, many trees died. 结果，许多树木死亡了。

Deprived of shade, the **moss** around the trees slowly **withered** and vanished under the **scorching sun**. 失去了树荫的遮蔽，树木周围的苔藓在烈日下慢慢枯萎并消失。

The damage these **herbivores** caused to the ecosystem was like a deep, gaping **wound** that would not **heal**. 这些食草动物对生态系统造成的破坏，就像一道深深的、张开的伤口，久久无法愈合。

第二段

To **prevent** the situation **from** getting worse, in 1995, officials decided to **reintroduce** wolves. 为了防止情况进一步恶化，1995年，官方决定重新引入狼群。

Upon hearing the news, **ranchers** were **indignant**. 听到这个消息，牧场主们愤愤不平。

They **were skeptical about** whether this decision would actually be **carried out**. 他们对这一决定是否真的会被执行持怀疑态度。

To **head this off**, ranchers **banded together**, **objecting** to this plan and demanding **hearings**. 为了阻止这一切，牧场主们联合起来，反对这项计划，并要求举行听证会。

They claimed this was an **insult** to their way of life, as wolves would **prey on** their **livestock**. 他们声称这是对他们生活方式的侮辱，因为狼会捕食他们的牲畜。

If wolves returned, the constant struggle to **resist** these **vicious** predators would **torment** them **endlessly**. 如果狼回来了，为了抵御这些凶残的捕食者而进行的持续斗争将会无休止地折磨他们。

However, ecologists **took the opposite view**. 然而，生态学家们**持相反的观点**。

They **cared little for** how these **shepherds** felt; all they wanted was for Yellowstone to **revive**. 他们**不太在乎 这些 牧羊人**的感受；他们只想让黄石公园**恢复生机**。

第三段

The plan that many had deemed **dubious** went ahead as scheduled, yet the results far exceeded **estimates**. 这项被许多人认为**不靠谱的**计划如期推进，而结果却远远超出了**预期**。

Elk no longer **dared to roam** near the open **ridges**, for **cunning** gray wolves now **lurked** there, ready to **pursue** them at any moment. 麋鹿不再 **敢 在开阔的山脊附近漫步**，因为**狡猾的**灰狼如今**潜伏**在那里，随时准备**追捕**它们。

Free from **relentless** grazing, greenery returned, its rapid **expansion** soon transforming the entire **panorama**. 摆脱了**无休止的**啃食，绿色植被回归了，它的快速**扩张**很快改变了整个**景观**。

Where elk had left the land **desolate**, new life now **stretched** across it once more—**lush** and **thriving**. 在麋鹿曾经使土地变得**荒芜的**地方，新的生命如今再次**蔓延**开来——**郁郁葱葱，生机勃勃**。

In a Yellowstone reborn, beavers also **made their way back**—to **swamp** and stream. 在重生的黄石公园里，海狸也**回来了**——回到**沼泽和溪流**中。

第四段

Yellowstone's **rebirth** brought unexpected **clarity** on how to **maintain ecological balance** in the future. 黄石公园的**重生**为未来如何**维持生态平衡**带来了意想不到的**清晰认识**。

The key lay not in killing, but in fear. 关键不在于杀戮，而在于恐惧。

Gray wolves do more than just kill elk and control their numbers; their fierce **disposition instills** lasting fear in their **prey**. 灰狼所做的不仅仅是猎杀麋鹿、控制它们的数量；它们凶猛的**性情**还会在**猎物**心中**灌输**持久的恐惧。

As a result, elk now **wander** within a limited range, doing everything they can to avoid places where wolves **howl**. 因此，麋鹿现在只在有限的范围内**游荡**，尽一切可能避开狼群**嚎叫**的地方。

This greatly shrinks the area damaged by elk **grazing**, giving other areas time to recover. 这大大缩小了被麋鹿**啃食**破坏的区域，让其他地方有了恢复的时间。

It is this behavioral shift that **underlies** much of the **restoration**. 正是这种行为转变**构成了**大部分生态**恢复**的基础。

第五段

The **resounding** success soon rippled beyond ecology. 这一**巨大的**成功很快波及到了生态领域之外。

Visitors arrived in growing numbers, **hiking** along the valley **rim at their leisure**, hoping to **catch a glimpse of** the **elusive** gray wolves. 游客们纷至沓来，**悠闲地**沿着山谷的**边缘***** * 徒步**，希望能**一睹***** * 难觅踪迹的**灰狼的风采。

Local tourism operators **scored** big—**abundant** revenue **poured in**, giving the economy a significant boost. 当地旅游经营者**大获成功**——**丰厚的收入涌入**，给经济带来了显著的提振。

Ranchers, however, were **up in arms**. 然而，牧场主们却**怒不可遏**。

As wolf populations grew, so did livestock kills. 随着狼群数量的增长，牲畜被杀的数量也在增加。

Some ranchers began organizing hunts on their own. 一些牧场主开始自行组织猎杀行动。

To **defuse** the **rising tensions**, authorities were forced to introduce a **compensation** policy: ranchers who lost livestock could now **file claims**. 为了**化解**日益加剧的紧张局势**，当局被迫出台了一项**补偿**政策：失去牲畜的牧场主现在可以**提出索赔**。

This **concession** helped **soften** the opposition. 这一**让步**有助于**缓和**反对声音。

第六段

Other regions now **pursue** similar outcomes. 其他地区如今也在**追求**类似的成果。

In Germany, wolves have crossed the **border** from Poland—and the boost to ecosystem recovery is already visible. 在德国，狼群已经从波兰越过了**边境**——对生态系统恢复的推动作用已经清晰可见。

Farmers, though, have **groaned** over their **mounting** losses and **pointed fingers at** government policy. 然而，农民们却为**不断增加的损失**而**叫苦不迭**，并将**矛头**指向**政府政策。

In response, **Parliament** drew up **clauses** to safeguard their interests and property. 作为回应，**议会**制定了**条款**来保障他们的利益和财产。

The **entity** responsible for overseeing wildlife **conceded** limited culls—but kept core populations **intact**. 负责监管野生动物的**机构**同意**进行有限的猎杀——但保持核心种群**完好无损**。

第七段

Ecologists **counsel** patience. 生态学家们**建议**保持耐心。

After all, ecosystem recovery is not **instantaneous**—it takes decades to restore the **delicate bonds** between species. **毕竟**，生态系统的恢复不是一**蹴而就的**——恢复物种之间的**微妙纽带**需要几十年的时间。

Yet for all this complexity, Yellowstone offers a **concise** lesson: remove a keystone species, the balance collapses; **revive** it, nature **heals** itself. 然而，尽管如此复杂，黄石公园提供了一个**简明的**教训：移除一个关键物种，平衡就会崩溃；**恢复**它，自然就会自我**愈合**。